

The KeLatic Story

*Why this book exists — and what it actually cost to
build the blueprint*

*“When you decide to do someone’s hair,
you’re not just styling it. You’re giving them
an experience they carry with them long after
they leave your chair.”*

ROCKAL

◆ Let Me Tell You What Nobody Told Me

KeLatic Hair Lounge was not built overnight, and it was not built on talent alone. I had the hands. Plenty of stylists have the hands. What I did not have — what nobody in beauty school hands you — was the truth: the difference between a struggling stylist and a thriving business owner has almost nothing to do with how good your retwist is. It is systems. It is strategy. It is the courage to build something bigger than the chair you are standing behind.

I learned that the expensive way. Years of fully booked weeks that somehow ended with an empty account. Years of being the most requested stylist in the room and still doing my books through DMs at midnight. Every lesson in this book cost me something — time, money, sleep, or all three. You get to pay a much smaller price: the price of this book, and the discipline to actually use it.

But before I hand you the blueprint, I want you to understand what it actually cost to build it — because doing hair is never really about the hair.

◆ **More Than a Service**

Over the years, I've done a little bit of everything. Weaves. Natural hair. Silk presses. Braids. I've sat behind more chairs, learned more techniques, and touched more kinds of hair than I can count. I even did relaxers for a while — and I'll tell you now, you couldn't pay me to touch one today. I saw what it did. So I dedicated my time to going all natural, and eventually I went straight into locs, because I wanted to actually understand the education behind them, not just the technique.

And what I learned along the way is this: it was never just about the hair. It's about the experience you give someone while they're sitting in your chair. Anybody can learn a technique. Not everybody can make a person feel like themselves again.

◆ **The Nights Nobody Saw**

I had to learn the hard way what it means to be booked and booked, and still be missing from your own life. Booked weeks kept me away from my family. I was at the salon day and night, chasing clients, doing the kind of marketing nobody has to do anymore. In 2026 you can build a following from your phone. Back then, it was different — we passed out flyers by the thousands. No sleep. No sleep. No sleep.

That was the price of the beginning. And it's the biggest problem I created for myself over the years: I never had enough time for my family, because I was stuck behind the chair.

◆ Building a Team, Not Just a Staff

So I made a decision. I made it bigger. I built a brand. I brought in employees — team members who could help me actually run a business, not just fill a chair.

But here's what nobody warns you about: I was looking for people like me. I love people. I'm a people person, honestly a people pleaser. And what I kept running into instead were people who were only there for the money. They wanted to do hair, get the client in and out, and move to the next one. No conversation. No connection. Just a transaction.

I'm still dealing with that today. Finding good people — people who actually care about the person in the chair, not just the service — is hard. It doesn't get easier just because the business gets bigger. So even now, when my team isn't where I need it to be, I'm the one working harder to make sure the business still stands strong and tall.

Because I am interested in people. I want to know their story. I remember everything about them. So when someone walks into the salon, they're not just getting a service — they're getting an experience. Sometimes you're their stylist. Sometimes you're their therapist. You don't know what's going on in their family, in their life — but you can make them feel good in that chair. Confident. Seen. That's what keeps people coming back, long after the flyers stopped working.

FROM THE CHAIR

*I've been through the rain and the storms nobody else knew about.
Nobody saw those nights. They just saw the salon full.*

◆ Where I Actually Started

If there's one thing I want you to take from my story before you take anything from this book, it's this: I can never tell anybody to give up.

I started doing hair because I had a felony on my record. I was working at Metro at the time, driving with my CDL, and attending hair school on the side. When Metro found out about my felony, that was it for that job. At the time, it felt like the worst thing that could have happened to me. I had nothing, no one, and I was struggling. I had no car. I was riding the bus with my one-year-old, just trying to make it. But that moment made me stronger. It pushed me into a mindset where I was determined never to depend on anything or anyone again.

So I went all in. I started searching for a salon to work at, but I had no clients and I was barely making money. That's when I stumbled onto Elevations Hair Studio, and that was a blessing. It was an amazing shop — but even there, I had no clients at first, and I still wasn't making enough to survive. I couldn't pay booth rent. The owner was patient with me anyway. I spent days and nights marketing on foot, going out and promoting myself wherever I could. I was determined to build something from nothing.

That's why I say this so strongly: these days, a lot of stylists want things handed to them on a platter. But I learned early that what you give is what you get. The work, the sacrifice, the consistency — that's what creates opportunity.

I've been running this business since 2010, and it has not been easy. But I am deeply grateful for every person and every lesson that helped shape me along the way.

So if you're reading this wondering whether your start is too messy, too late, or too far behind — it isn't. You can do anything you put your mind to.

WHAT FOLLOWS

This is just the start of the book. What follows is the breakdown.

